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Yelp Features Report
CSCI 275

Common Features of Yelp with Competition

- 1) User and featured reviews
- 2) Local restaurant database
- 3) Search filters
- 4) Maps and location services
- 5) Photos and menus
- 6) Reservations
- 7) Rating systems
- 8) Categories
- 9) Contact information
- 10) Restaurant Description
- 11) Support page
- 12) Careers page
- 13) Cookie management
- 14) Country selection
- 15) Privacy policy
- 16) User profiles
- 17) Recommendation engine
- 18) Restaurant listings
- 19) Login information not needed
- 20) Searches can be sorted (depending on reviews and ratings)

Yelp-Specific Features

- 1) **Elite Reviewer Program**
 - Has a specific filter that lists reviews from people with a review history on the app
- 2) **Yelp Deals and Offers**
 - Provides occasional discounts based on holiday, events etc
- 3) **Personalized Ranking System**
 - Suggestions based off user activity, previous searches etc
- 4) **Recent Activity**
 - Displays reviews that are recently uploaded
- 5) **Events Showcase**
 - Displays events that are happening in restaurants (date and time)
- 6) **Business Owner Responses**
 - Owners can publicly reply to customer reviews.
- 7) **Request a Quote System** (Not really for restaurants)
 - you can request a quote for services directly from businesses by filling out a small form.
- 8) **Popular Dishes Highlight**
 - Yelp identifies frequently mentioned menu items from reviews and displays them to the users.

9) Competitive Pricing

- Yelp gives you a catalogue of businesses and restaurants in similar price ranges.

10) Yelp Friends

- Shows you recent activity of your "friends" you added on yelp.

11) Ad preference

- Users can choose the ads they are comfortable with.

12) Yelp Advertisement

- Restaurants can create an account and advertise their businesses as ads as well.

13) Bookmark feature

- Users can bookmark their restaurants

14) User freedom

- Users can add their own pictures of the business rather than only business controlling it.

15) Reward system

- Trusted users are given badges and recognition

16) Review Voting

- People can agree or disagree on opinions on the reviews

17) Check in features

- Helps users mark the places they visited

18) Estimated wait times

- It shows the live predicted wait times which can help users save time

19) Verified reviews

- Filters fake or suspicious reviews

20) Dietary restrictions

- Allows users to set dietary preferences such as Kosher, vegan, gluten free

Cons:

1. Heavy focus on popular businesses

- Well known restaurants get more attention, while smaller and newer places stay hidden.

2. Heavy review filtering

- It lowers spam but could end up not showing real reviews.

3. Need to pay for AI bot

- Users will have to pay to use AI to know more.